

Week 12 - A small recovery without Google

Week ending 22 May 2026

Snapshot

Account value	£1,983.39
Week 11 value	£1,974.37
Weekly move	+£9.02 / +0.46%
Starting cost basis	£1,999
Overall result	-£15.61 / -0.78%
Cash	£246.34
Main trade	No new trade assumed; Google still not re-entered

The account moved the right way

Week 12 was better than Week 11, although it was not a big breakout. The account moved from £1,974.37 to £1,983.39, so the portfolio recovered by £9.02. That is not a huge move, but it brought the account closer to the original cost basis again.

The useful part was that the portfolio did not need Google in the account to stabilise. The cash stayed available, and the improvement came from the remaining holdings, mainly ASML, Symbolic and Rheinmetall. At the same time, NextEra, gold and Meta held the account back, so it was not a clean rally.

What happened underneath

The wider market was mixed. Early in the week, investors were still worried about inflation, oil and bond yields, which was not helpful for rate-sensitive names like NextEra. Later in the week, sentiment improved as investors became more positive about progress in the Middle East conflict and corporate earnings remained supportive.

Europe was stronger, especially technology and defence. That helped ASML and Rheinmetall after both had been frustrating recently. Gold was weaker again because higher yields and a firmer dollar made it harder for the hedge to help.

The position impact

Holding	Weekly move	£ impact	My note
ASML	+7.1%	+£9.16	Good rebound after last week's weakness.
Symbotic	+13.3%	+£8.22	Sharp bounce, but still volatile.
Rheinmetall	+8.6%	+£7.45	Useful recovery after the defence-stock reset.
Realty Income	+0.7%	+£0.98	Slightly positive, still rate-sensitive.
QQQA	+0.5%	+£0.69	Nasdaq exposure held up after the Week 11 trim.
Berkshire Hathaway	Flat	£0.00	Did its job as a steady holding.
VUAG	Flat	£0.00	Broad market exposure stayed steady.
Airbnb	-1.2%	-£1.42	Slightly weaker, not a major issue by itself.
Meta	-1.4%	-£3.39	Softer week after helping in Week 11.
SGLN / Gold	-1.4%	-£4.38	Hedge dragged again.
NextEra	-5.9%	-£8.17	Biggest weekly drag.

My takeaway

ASML was the best sign because it reminded me why the semiconductor infrastructure theme still mattered. Symbotic's bounce helped, but I did not want to treat one strong week as proof the risk had gone. Rheinmetall finally had a better week, but I still would not average down aggressively unless it stabilised properly.

The account was still slightly below the starting value, but it had moved in the right direction. That was enough for Week 12.